

Middle East's deepening crisis will keep crude prices above \$100

送信者: EG Energy, Climate & Resources 受信日時: 2026-09-15 03:34

【メール原文】

Oil is unlikely to fall below \$100 soon. A successful drone attack on the Saudi East-West pipeline has taken 4 million bpd off the market and driven a|||||||

Oil Markets Weekly

[Customize Email Preferences](#)

Middle East's deepening crisis will keep crude prices above \$100

14 Sep 2026 14:32 EDT [Discover more on the Portal](#)

*

A successful drone attack on the East-West pipeline in Saudi Arabia has cut 4 million barrels per day (bpd) from the market, causing prices to soar above \$100 per barrel for Brent.

*

Saudi Arabia is likely to repair the damage that shut down the pipeline, but the timeline is unclear and the risk of continued attack will remain acute.

*

Tanker attacks will keep pushing up shipping rates, as the conflict is turning into a broader shipping crisis.

Oil is unlikely to fall below \$100 soon. A successful drone attack on the Saudi East-West pipeline has taken 4 million bpd off the market and driven a sharp spike in oil prices, with the Brent front month climbing to nearly \$110 per barrel, before falling back to \$105.

While the US continues to escort oil tankers out of the Strait of Hormuz, regional flows will fall until the pipeline is repaired. The timeline remains unclear because the attack caused heavy damage to the line's pumping stations.

Prices are unlikely to fall back into their former \$75-\$95 range (see: Standoff now likely to run through 2026, as Hormuz traffic increases , 1 September 2026), as Chinese demand is showing signs of recovery and physical prices for crude and refined products continue to rise. Eurasia Group will publish revised price bands later this week to account for the changes in market conditions.

Prices are surging as the Middle East conflict shows no signs of winding down. Houthi escalation against Saudi Arabia (see: Saudi cannot reverse Houthi seizure of Bab al-Mandeb, raising risk of oil disruptions , 10 September 2026) and successful drone attacks on Saudi energy infrastructure have coincided with the ongoing US-Iran confrontation in the Strait of Hormuz, including continued Iranian attacks on shipping and occasional US strikes on Iranian tankers and Iran itself.

While neither side appears interested in significantly escalating the confrontation in the strait and returning to more intense military operations, nor is there much chance of a diplomatic breakthrough in the conflict.

The regional escalation of the Middle East conflict is turning into a shipping crisis. The crisis affects all waters around the entire Arabian Peninsula, adding costs to oil and gas and feeding inflation. Dozens of attacks have been reported against civilian merchant vessels over the past weeks to the UK Maritime Trade Operations, which monitors security in the region.

Rates for Very Large Crude Carriers (VLCCs) have climbed to about \$150,000 per day, according to Fearnleys ship brokers. A VLCC can hold 2 million barrels of crude oil. Middle East-to-China VLCC rates hit a record of \$800,000 per day.

Rates for Suezmax tankers have also surged to record highs exceeding \$100,000 per day. These tankers are the biggest vessels that can transit the Suez Canal fully laden (1 million barrels of crude).

The risk to shipping poses a major threat to the global economy. More than 80% of global trade is transported by sea. An association of 18 nations that rely heavily on maritime trade known as the Consultative Shipping Group (CSG) last week issued a rare warning. "Recent events demonstrate how fragile our system of maritime trade can be," the CSG said in a statement. "Without maritime trade, supply chains would fragment and the global economy as we know it would come to a sudden halt," it warned.

Gregory Brew

Senior Analyst, Iran & Energy

+1 646 259 3207

brew@eurasiagroup.net

Henning Gloystein

Managing Director, Energy & Resources

+44 (0)73 898 444 98

gloystein@eurasiagroup.net

EG Energy, Climate & Resources

ecr@eurasiagroup.net

© 2026 Eurasia Group. All rights reserved. This material was produced by Eurasia Group for use by the recipient. This is intended as general background research and is not intended to constitute advice on any particular commercial investment or trade matter or issue and should not be relied upon for such purposes. It is not to be made available to any person other than the recipient. No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means, electronic or otherwise, without the prior consent of Eurasia Group.

X-HG-DocID cmu1jx8pcezxI07lvomlczh77

Opt Out | Customize Email Preferences